CETACEAN MYSTERY!

A Crown of Teeth

Coronodon havensteini inhabited the seas off present-day South Carolina roughly 28–30 million years ago. Its original fossil was discovered in the Ashley Formation along the Wando River, near Charleston. Its species name honours its discoverer, Mark Havenstein.

Estimated at around five metres long,

DID YOU KNOW?

In this reconstruction, Zygophyseter varolai is portrayed as a predatory sperm whale known as the “abyssal ripper,” characterized by deep mandibular alveoli—deep tooth sockets in the lower jaw. Measuring an estimated 6.5–7 metres, with some specimens suggesting over 9 metres, this formidable hunter carried 13 pairs of upper teeth and 14 pairs below. Its enamel-crowned teeth, substantial